

# Business Continuity & Fallback Procedure

Document Reference: CAW-SOP-BCP-2026-01  
System: Case Ace v2.0 Client Consultation Recording & Note Drafting System  
Organisation: Citizens Advice Wandsworth (CAW)  
Target Audience: All Advisers, Caseworkers, Supervisors, and Bureau Managers  
Status: Formally Approved Business Continuity Procedure  
Classification: Internal / Operational

## 1. Core Principle: Zero Operational Dependency

[!IMPORTANT]

The Baseline Principle of Business Continuity:  
Case Ace v2.0 is an assistive productivity tool, NOT a mission-critical operating system or core dependency.

When Case Ace is unavailable for any reason (cloud outage, network failure, software bug, or local device issue), the business continuity procedure is simply the existing, standard operational practice of Citizens Advice Wandsworth: advisers take notes by hand on paper or type them directly into Casebook CRM during and immediately following the consultation.

Client appointments must NEVER be cancelled, postponed, or delayed due to Case Ace unavailability.

## 2. Trigger Events for Business Continuity Activation

The standard manual note-taking procedure is activated immediately upon any of the following events:

| BUSINESS CONTINUITY TRIGGER MATRIX |                                           |                  |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Trigger Event                      | Technical Indicator / Symptom             | Fallback Action  |
| **Cloud Provider Outage**          | Google Cloud STT or Vertex AI unreachable | Revert to Manual |
| **Local Bureau Internet Failure**  | Bureau broadband / WiFi offline           | Revert to Manual |
| **Local Browser Crash / Bug**      | Application frozen or fails to load WASM  | Revert to Manual |
| **Webex Telephony API Failure**    | Softphone audio stream uncapturable       | Revert to Manual |
| **Client Expresses Reluctance**    | Client declines audio recording           | Revert to Manual |

## 3. The Standard Manual Operating Procedure (The Fallback Process)

When Case Ace is unavailable or bypassed:

```
flowchart LR
    A["Case Ace Unavailable / Offline"] --> B["1. Proceed with Client Appointment as Scheduled"]
    B --> C["2. Take Contemporaneous Notes (Paper or Casebook)"]
    C --> D["3. Author AQS Level 3 Note Directly in Casebook CRM"]
    D --> E["4. Save Case Activity & Mark Complete"]
```

### Step-by-Step Manual Process:

Proceed with Appointment: Welcome the client and begin the advice interview without mentioning system technicalities.

Contemporaneous Note-Taking:

Write contemporaneous notes on an approved CAW paper consultation notepad or type directly into an open Case Activity draft in Casebook CRM.

Capture key dates, debt amounts, benefit references, and household circumstances.

Drafting and Case Recording:

Structure the note using standard AQS Level 3 headings: Confirmation of Enquiry, Advice Given, and Agreed Action Plan.

Ensure all statutory deadlines (e.g. 1-month Mandatory Reconsideration windows, court hearing dates) are explicitly recorded.

Disposal of Paper Notes:

If handwritten notes were taken on paper, transfer them into Casebook CRM.

Once verified in Casebook, immediately place the paper consultation notes into the confidential shredding console.

## 4. Technical Recovery and Resumption Protocol

| +-----+<br>  TECHNICAL RECOVERY WORKFLOW<br>+-----+            |                                                               |                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| +-----+<br>  Step   Action Taken by IT Support Team<br>+-----+ |                                                               | +-----+<br>  Communication Channel<br>+-----+ |
| 1.                                                             | Verify status of Google Cloud Vertex AI / STT in europe-west2 | Google Cloud Status Dashboard                 |
| 2.                                                             | Restart backend API container / Nginx reverse proxy if needed | Internal Service Monitoring                   |
| 3.                                                             | Run automated health checks & smoke tests                     | `npm run test:prod-health`                    |
| 4.                                                             | Broadcast "Service Restored" notice to bureau staff           | Internal Teams / Staff Email                  |
| 5.                                                             | Advisers may resume using Case Ace for subsequent sessions    | Standard SOP Resumed                          |
| +-----+                                                        |                                                               |                                               |

No Backlog or Data Sync Needed: Because Case Ace operates strictly in volatile RAM with zero persistent database records or server-side queues, an outage creates zero backlogged data to reconcile or recover. Once the service is online, new sessions begin cleanly.